personality, inclination towards violence, differences with the Afghan Army, and rivalry with the Khalq, Afghanistan's future looked bleak to Daulet Singh.[72] While S. K. Singh's judgment prevailed, Daulet Singh's words left their mark. Officially, India welcomed Daud and called him a 'great' leader who would strengthen the 'sovereignty' and 'independence' of the Afghan people (clearly a reference towards Pakistan's interference in domestic Afghan affairs).[73] Unofficially, however, India worried of the potential balkanisation of the subcontinent were Pakistan to break-up further.[74]

There were concerns that Daud's provocation on Pashtunistan and Balochistan—both due to his own anti-Pakistan rhetoric and under pressure from his PDPA partners and rivals alike—would exacerbate the situation. EAM Swaran Singh, in his address to the Lok Sabha, euphemistically termed Daud's initiatives towards Pakistan, 'courageous'. It was a polite way of saying that Kabul was on a dangerous collision course with Islamabad.[75] Lalit Mansingh, then India's deputy high commissioner to Kabul (1971–75), who later became foreign secretary, agrees that 'Daud was very anti-Pakistan and wanted us [India] to be actively involved in containing Pakistan'.[76] Daud's proposal to New Delhi was that it should militarily engage Pakistan in the east, and Afghanistan would fight in the west, and together they will 'fix' Pakistan (even though he ridiculed allegations of an India-Afghanistan nexus in public).[77] In a highly publicised visit to New Delhi in March 1975, Daud made his position amply clear:

> The one and only political difference between Afghanistan and Pakistan concerns the restoration of the legitimate rights of our Pakhtoon and Baloochis brothers. We have always expressed our willingness to settle this only difference with that country, but we see that Pakistan is not ready to give a positive response to our desire in this regard. Various governments in Pakistan have consistently employed fear from other countries in the region as an instrument for internal stability and procuring arms, while it is Pakistan itself, which by joining various military pacts, stockpiling various kinds of arms has aroused the concern of the countries in the region and disturbed the tranquility and stability in the area.[78]

Having failed to secure Pakistan's territorial integrity in 1971, the US had lifted an arms embargo on Islamabad in light of its struggles in Balochistan and the NWFP. Though this was a matter of concern for India (it became a major discussion point in the parliament), the arms consignments were not big enough to alter the strategic balance that was in India's favour after the 1971 war. New Delhi refused to join Daud in his criticism of the US and Pakistan (to